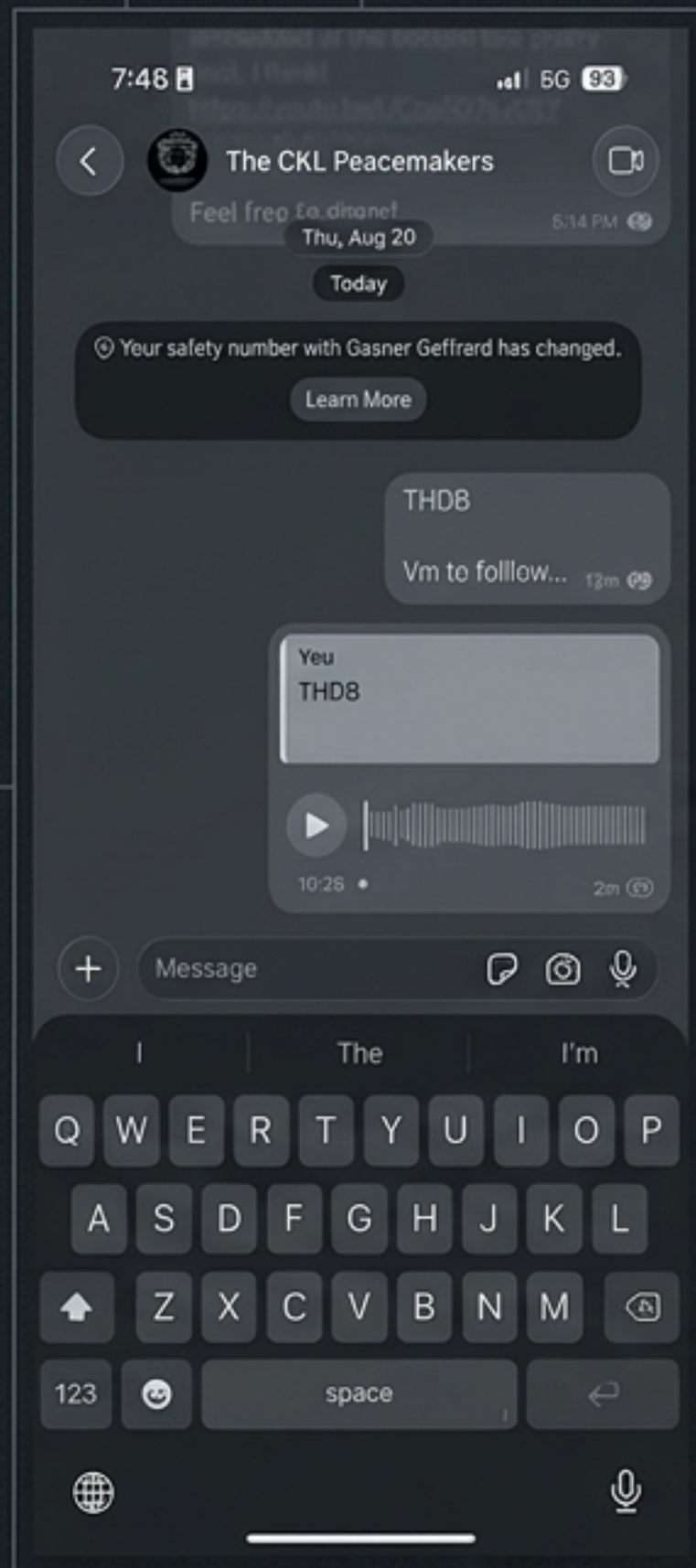
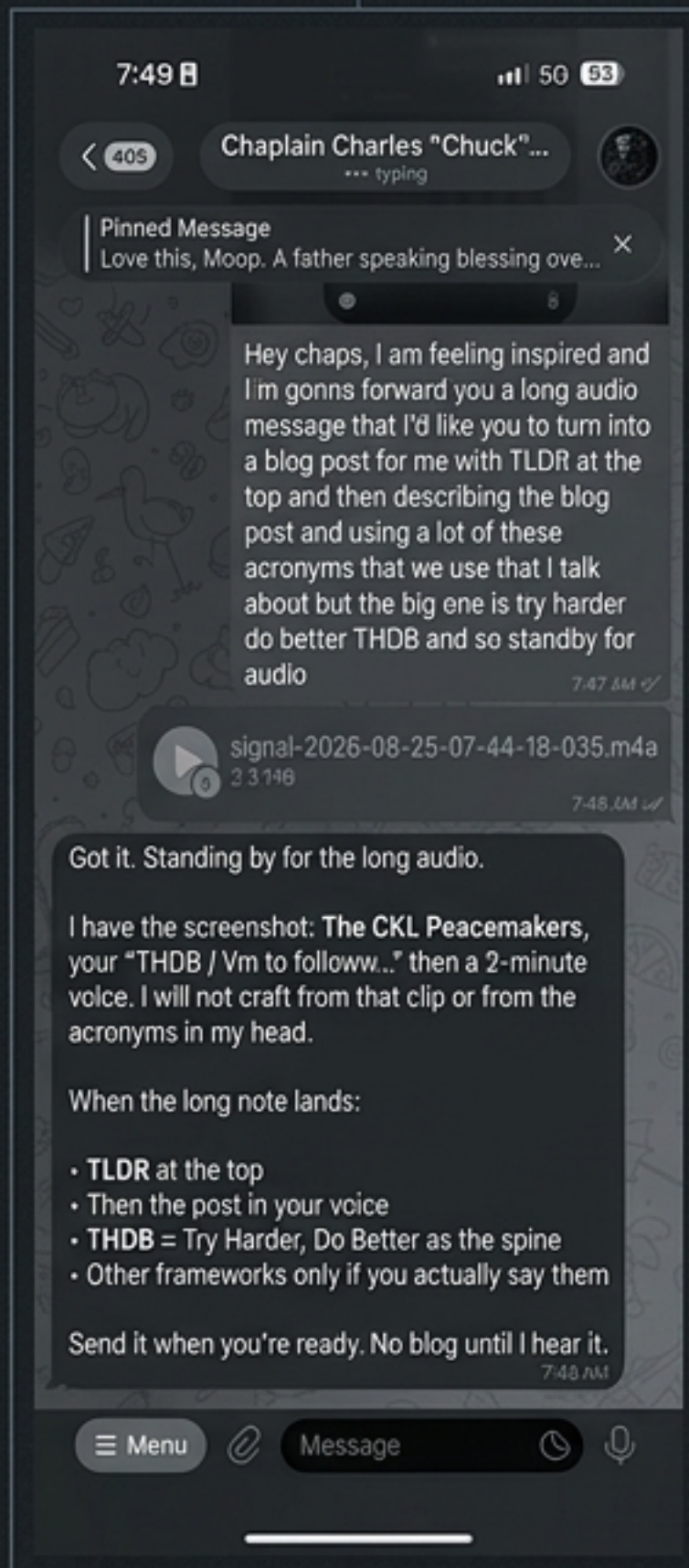




Corrected Coordinates

Reclaiming the “Try Harder, Do Better” Directive for Christian Men

A Field Memo by Adam ‘MOOP’ Johns | U.S.M.C. Ministries



We hit the brakes at the yellow light.

Some doors close because the Lord closed them. When a red light shows up, you stop. This leaves you confused—you thought you had that door, but you don't see the next one yet.

This is a field memo for the forced pause. A time to mature, reassess the marital landscape, and correct our coordinates.

The blunt instrument of marital counsel.



THOB

Try Harder; Do Better.

This is the default advice most men receive when the marriage is tight, the kids are hard, or work will not yield.

There is no diagnosis. There is no Scripture with both sides on the table. Just: grind, be nicer, lead better. We are keeping the acronym, but changing its aim from a beating to a precise direction.

The disparity of pulpit accountability

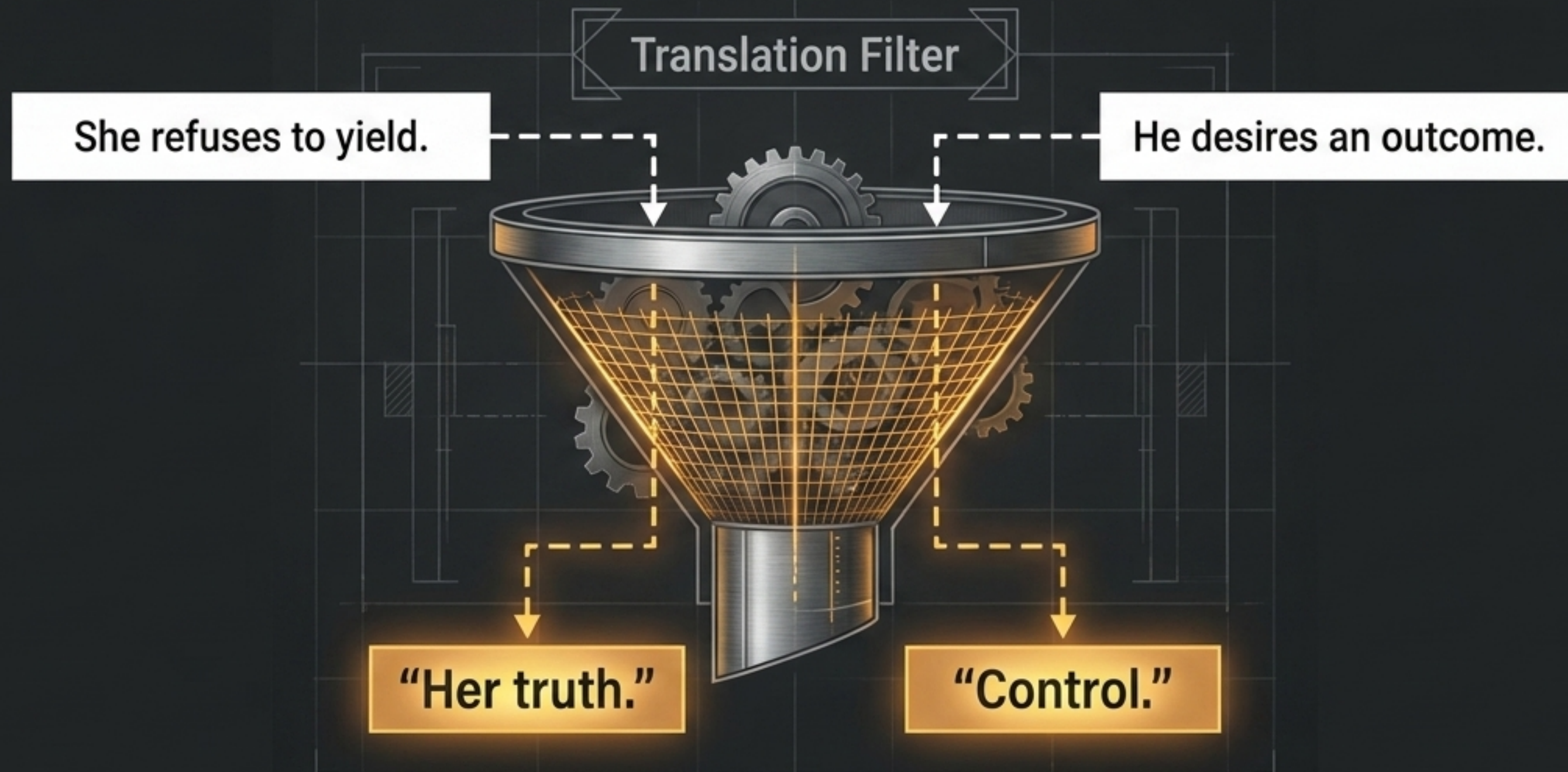


The 7 A's Disparity Matrix		
1	Mother's Day Sermon:	"She can do no wrong." (High Affirmation / Zero Accountability)
2	Father's Day Sermon:	The traditional beat-up. (Zero Affirmation / High Accountability)

It is easy to punch a man in the pulpit and call it preaching. Men can take a hit, but disparity matters in authentic relationships. Give both: tell the truth (alētheia), affirm, and hold the line.

Culture provides permission structures that hide feminine sin.

The church rarely preaches against feminine sins, but pride is still pride, whether in a man or a woman. If the only sin the room knows how to name is his, you do not get peace. You get a managed husband.



The yield that only runs in one direction.

Path A

Wife's
Grievance



Goes to
Counsel



Admonition to
compromise



**Husband
Yields.**

Path B

Husband's
Grievance



Wife "doesn't
want to"



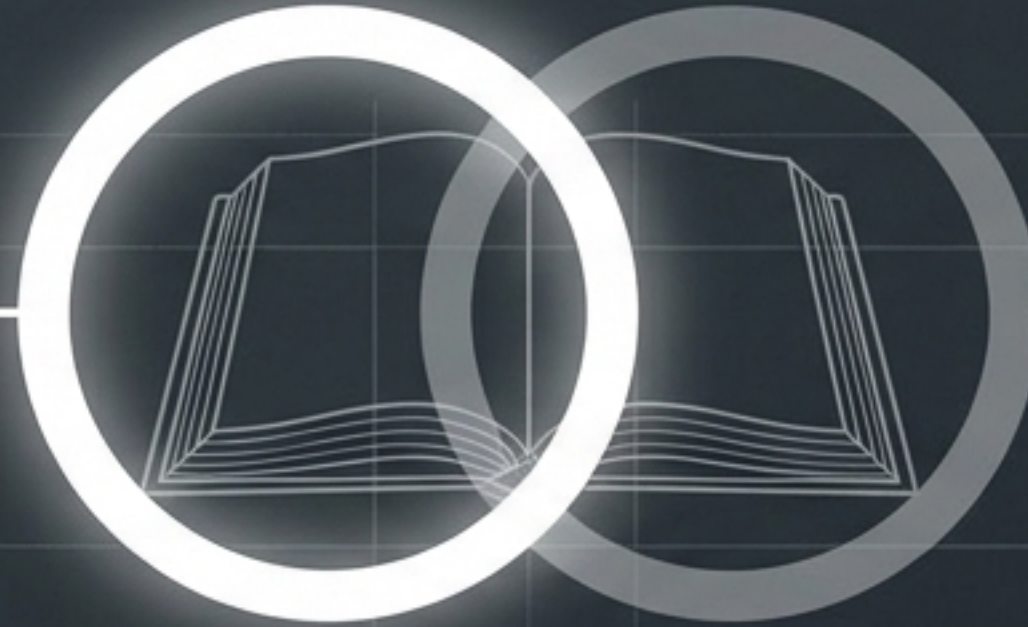
Counsel says
"stop wanting it"



**Husband
Yields.**

If "love" (*agapaō*) always means he yields, and "peace" always means he kills his want, you have not interpreted Ephesians 5. You have edited it.

Two rings, one Book. Reclaiming the Ephesian standard.



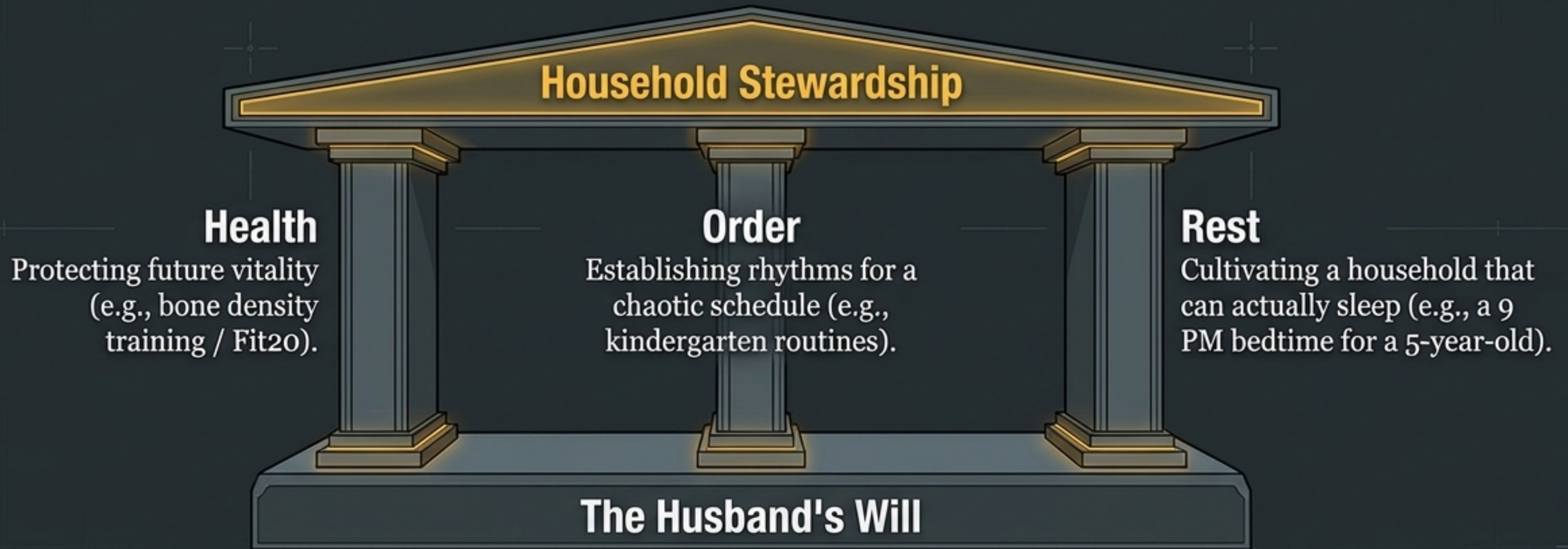
“Submit one to another...
Husbands lay your lives down
for your wives.” (Eph 5:21, 25)

“Wives, submit (*hupotassō*)
to your husband as to the Lord,
in everything.” (Eph 5:22-24)

Ephesians 5 is not a bargaining table. God wants us all to
do things we may not want to do from time to time.

The husband's will for ordinary good.

A husband is not a tyrant for having a will. He is not demanding a ten-course meal or a fantasy morning. A husband thinking ahead asks for ordinary good, and should not apologize for wanting it.



The Counseling Script vs. The Ephesian Standard.

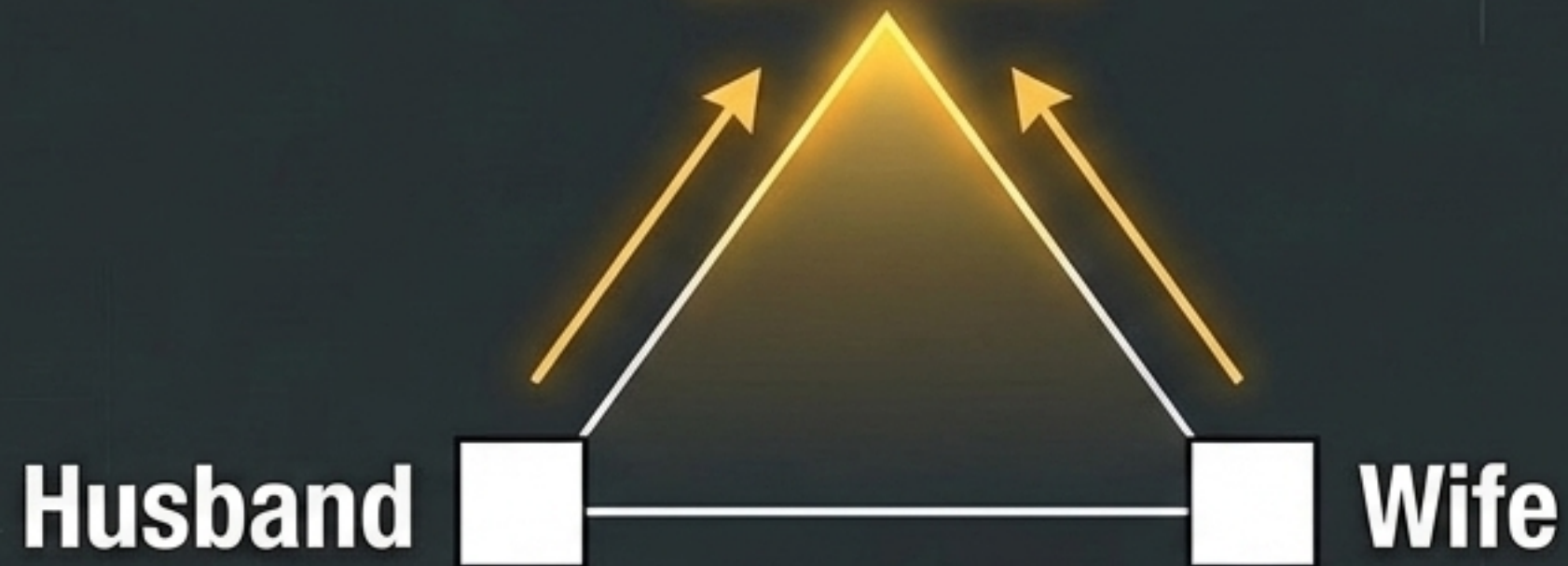
The Cultural Script	The Ephesian Standard
The husband yields or disappears.	Both submit under the same Lord.
Her sin is “her truth”; his desire is “control”.	Sin is named equally; ordinary good is pursued mutually.
A one-way street toward the wife’s preference.	Mutual submission in everything.

True peace is vertical, not horizontal.



Ephesians 5 is not a bargaining table where two opposing parties negotiate a compromise until one gives up.

One Lord



Peace is not achieved by the husband disappearing.
Peace is achieved when both individuals are aligned under the same Lord.

THDB: The Tactical Checklist

THDB is not “try harder to disappear.” It is a directive for how we talk.

Try Harder

- To tell the truth (*alētheia*) without making her the enemy.
- To dwell with your wife in understanding (gnōsis, 1 Peter 3:7).

Do Better

- At asking like a husband instead of a prosecutor.
- At receiving a “no” without baptizing bitterness.

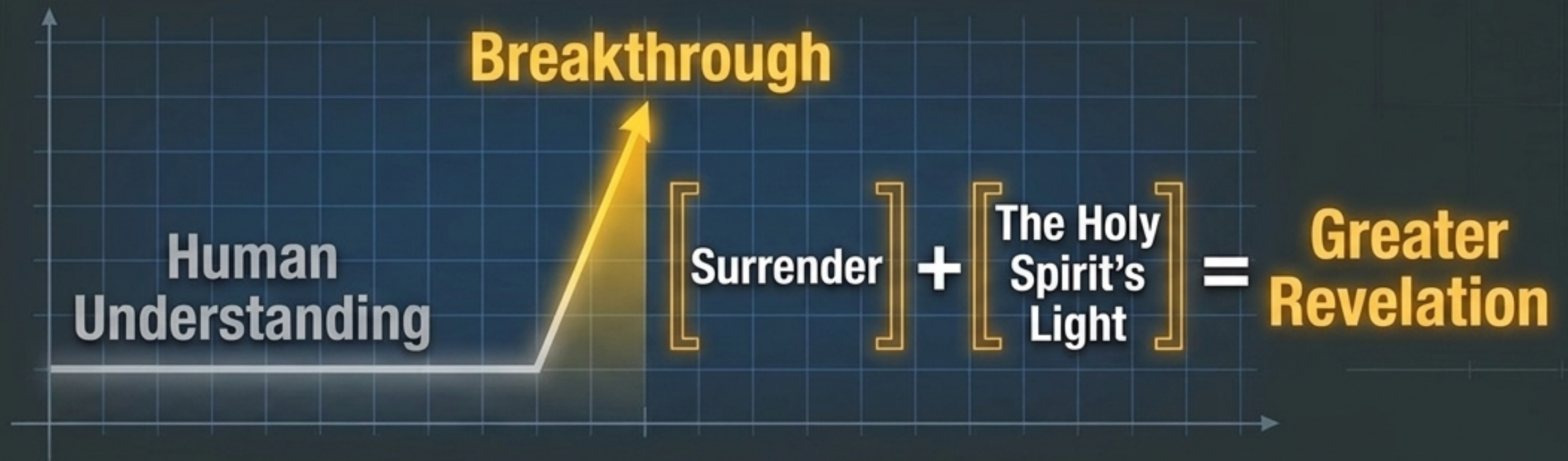
The incomplete sentence of 1 Peter 3:7.



We are commanded to dwell with our wives with understanding. Because men and women are different, husbands often conclude: “There are some things we have to understand that we will never understand.”

That is an **incomplete sentence**. It leaves out a critical condition. **We will never understand... UNLESS.**

The condition for breakthrough.



You must not call the sentence finished before the Spirit has spoken.
Closed doors still confuse and yellow lights still ask you to brake.

But when we surrender, the Holy Spirit
supernaturally reveals a greater understanding,
allowing us to see what was previously invisible.





Grow up anyway.

The red lights will still stop you. The yellow lights will still require the brakes. But the coordinates are now corrected.



Equip yourself for the next open door. Start the Watchman Bible Reading Plan (Five watches a day, built for men who lead) at U.S.M.C. Ministries.

